

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Transformation Leader | Company-Wide AI Adoption, Process Redesign, and Governance

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. I have spent fifteen years getting people to change how they work inside a business where Risk and Compliance could stop anything I built. At TIAA (\$1.5T AUM) I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform, led the team that built it, and owned it from use-case scoping through governance, rollout, and measurement. I carried one adoption operating model across seven Client Services business areas whose leaders did not report to me. On my own time I build agentic AI, including a four-agent system running live today. I have taken an AI product from an idea to a company-wide launch inside a business that could have stopped it, and I build working agents with my own hands.

AGENTIC AI I HAVE BUILT, OUTSIDE OF AN EMPLOYER

- **A four-agent interview simulator, live today.** Inside CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), which I designed and directed the build of. Four agents run in sequence with no human between the steps, analyzing a job description against a resume, designing a tailored question set, scoring answers in real time and deciding when to probe harder, then writing the coaching report. I owned what the system is not allowed to decide, which is why it will not auto-apply on anyone's behalf and will not produce a fabricated match score. CareerPointers is live and not yet opened to the public. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made this and Future Me, Answered real.
- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily, not a demo.** Each agent holds a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates catch overclaims on their way into live work, and they miss things, which is why a person still signs it. I published the methodology behind this practice in 2026.
- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live.** I designed the 5-stage discovery framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI, on Next.js with multi-provider AI so I could move providers if one degraded. It is in use by dozens of people on donated access.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Redesigning How the Work Gets Done

- **Gave back five floors of a Denver building and kept 700 people working through it.** Corporate Real Estate set the target and I directed the execution, moving 700 associates from assigned seating into a hoteling model and vacating five floors, roughly 44 percent of the Denver square footage, with no retention crisis. The business had been absorbing rent and occupancy on that space and what it absorbed came down with it. I later moved 500+ Client Services associates into the Frisco Corporate Center.
- **Seven business areas running one operating model, none of them mine.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own use cases. I set the operating rhythm, the prioritization, and the resource calls.

AI From Use Case to Company-Wide Rollout

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, governance, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it and I reached 1,500+ directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching, because you cannot send an email and call it adoption.
- **Measured adoption as active use, not headcount with access.** I defined the success measures, tracked them, and carried them to senior leaders through executive read-outs, business cases, and quarterly business reviews. Reach is not adoption and access is not usage, and I reported the difference rather than the flattering number.
- **Set the hard limits that let AI ship inside a regulated business.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII entered the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts and human oversight that keep a person in control of the decision. The system generated. It never acted.

Enterprise Budget, Data Exposure, and Vendor Selection

- **Built and negotiated a \$300K annual Client Services engagement budget with Finance,** inside roughly \$500K of Client Services program spend I administered, then showed what it bought.
- **Found the permission exposure any assistant would inherit.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT. An assistant surfaces to a person everything they already have permission to reach, so permission sprawl is a day-one exposure rather than a later phase.
- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise recognition platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. The evaluation discipline is what transfers.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **Sat on the sales side of enterprise recruiting-technology deals.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions. I was the engineer on the sales team and built what the reps used to win, scoping capability needs and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, and Regions Bank. I directed enhancements to recruiting solutions deployed for clients including Extra Space Storage, a multi-site operator hiring hourly at volume. I know what buyers of this software actually pay for, because I was across the table from them.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI Transformation and Operating Model: Enterprise AI Roadmap | Use-Case Intake, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Business Process Redesign | Adoption KPIs and Value Realization | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | AI Literacy and Capability Building | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer

Governance and Risk Partnership: Responsible AI Governance and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Data Privacy Remediation | Vendor Selection and RFP Scoring | Change Management

Enterprise and Executive: Executive Read-Outs and Business Cases | Client Services Engagement Budget Built and Negotiated (\$300K) | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | Enterprise Software Delivery | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA